Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, November 17, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Regional Councillors	-	S. Lee
		-	M. Crawford
	Councillors	-	R. Tyler Morin
		-	N. Henry
		-	L. Bower
Regrets:	Regional Councillor	-	J. Dies
	Mayor	-	S. Collier

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Deputy Mayor Lee called the meeting to order at 1:03 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on October 20, 2025 be adopted.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Deputy Mayor Lee invited questions on agenda items from those present.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1. Presentation: Human Resources Strategy Update

Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer, introduced Stacey Hushion, Vice President, StrategyCorp.

S. Hushion delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and recommendations contained therein.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. S. Hushion and N. Cooper, responded to questions from Council Members.

With the consent of Members present, item 7.3.2 was advanced in the order business.

7.3.2 **CS-2025-22: 2026-2029 Human Resources Strategy**

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

1. That the 2026-2029 Human Resources (HR) Strategy (ATT-1) be endorsed by Council in principle; and,

2. That any projects, initiatives, and resources identified therein for future years be considered as part of the annual budget process.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

With the consent of Members present, item 5.6 was advanced in the order business.

5.6. **Public Meeting: Temporary Use By-law – Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z5/25**
126-142 Commercial Avenue

Deputy Mayor Lee declared the meeting to be a public meeting and invited comments and questions from the public.

Francie Trajkovski, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Nicole Sabbage, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Sawa Tayeb, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Isabelle Graham-Redshaw, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Marla Walters, Pickering resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Margaret Eskins, Pickering resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Manssur Mobarak, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Niamatullah Mojadidi, Ajax business owner, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Fredrica Walters, Ajax resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Tameka Mercurius, Ajax resident, asked questions related to the proposed development application.

Angie Papas, Ajax resident, asked questions related to the proposed development application.

Abdul Khan, Ajax resident, expressed concerns and asked questions related to the proposed development application.

Mak Amiri, Ajax business owner, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Jason Durante, Ajax resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Aziz Amiri, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Caitlin Rae, Pickering resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

David Chung, Ajax business owner, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Yvette Alles, Ajax business owner, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Roy Safi, Ajax business owner, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Talha Khan, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Colleen O'Hara, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Heather McMillan, Ajax resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Gloria Small, Ajax resident, expressed concerns and asked questions related to the proposed development application.

Adam Smith, Ajax resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Alicia Radway, Ajax resident, expressed concerns related to the proposed development application.

Pamela Creary, Ajax resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

Mary Jane Manlacoe, Scarborough resident, expressed support for the proposed development application.

There being no further questions or comments from the public, Deputy Mayor Lee closed the public meeting.

Council recessed at 3:00 p.m.

Council resumed at 3:10 p.m.

Council Members asked questions related to the proposed development application. Jennifer Bishop, Project Manager, Long Term Care Development, The Regional Municipality of Durham, James Kilgour, Director of Special Projects, The Regional Municipality of Durham, Jonathan Dixon, Director, Business Affairs & Financial Management, The Regional Municipality of Durham, Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

K. Brownridge, G. Romanowski, J. Dixon, Jaclyn Grossi, Municipal Clerk, Julie Mepham, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer, and Christie McLardie, Director of Public & Strategic Affairs, responded to questions and concerns from the delegates.

With the consent of Members present, item 10.5 was advanced in the order of business.

10.5. **By-law 87-2025**

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law 87-2025 be approved.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

5.2. **Delegation: Accessibility Advisory Committee Annual Update**

Jim Lawrence, Accessibility Advisory Committee Member and Sarah Moore, Legislative Specialist, presented the Accessibility Advisory Committee Annual Update.

5.3. **Delegation: Heritage Advisory Committee Annual Update**

Stephen White, Heritage Advisory Committee Member, presented the Heritage Advisory Committee Annual Update.

Council Members asked questions related to the presentation. S. White responded to questions from Council Members.

5.4. **Delegation: Library Services 2025 Fall Update**

Piyali Correya, Library Board Chair, Ajax Public Library Board, presented the Library Services 2025 Fall Update.

With the consent of Members present, item 7.3.1. was advanced in the order of business.

7.3.1. **APL-2025-03: Library Services 2025 Fall Update**

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the Library Services 2025 Fall Update be received for information.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

5.5. **Delegation: 2025 Library Bookmark Contest Winners**

Sarah Vaisler, Chief Librarian & Executive Officer, presented the 2025 Library Book Contest Winners.

6. Correspondence

6.1. **City of Pickering – Support Frenchman's Bay Public Stewardship**

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the correspondence from the City of Pickering regarding "Support Frenchman's Bay Public Stewardship" be endorsed.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report

7.1.1 Community Affairs & Planning Committee, November 3, 2025

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated November 3, 2025 be adopted.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

7.2 General Government Committee Report

7.2.1. General Government Committee, November 10, 2025

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the General Government Committee Report dated November 10, 2025, be adopted.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Members provided updates from the Region related to Durham Region Transit (DRT) key performance indicators including safety, ridership, and service delivery, Ontario's One Fare program, and the DRT High School Ambassador Program.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of November 17, 2025 be received for information.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Exploring Commemorative Naming of an Impactful Space, Park, or Landmark that Honours Indigenous History

Councillor Bower and Regional Councillor Lee introduced the motion and reviewed its contents. Council Members asked questions related to the motion. C. McLardie and Yasmyn Belle, Equity, Diversity & Inclusion Coordinator, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: S. Lee

Whereas, the Truth and Reconciliation Commission's 94 Calls to Action (CTA), including CTA 43 and 57, encourage municipalities to adopt the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP), acknowledge and address colonial legacies, honour Indigenous cultures, and promote inclusive communities; and

Whereas, UNDRIP sets minimum standards for the survival, dignity, and well-being of Indigenous peoples, including recognition of cultural heritage and participation in decision-making; and

Whereas, commemorative naming is a symbolic yet meaningful step toward reconciliation, helping restore traditional Indigenous names, promote Indigenous languages, and strengthen cultural connections to the land; and

Whereas, Ajax Council approved a new Commemorative Naming Policy in September 2025 to enhance the process for commemorative naming of various parks, buildings, structures and assets; and

Whereas, the Town of Ajax has consulted Indigenous community partners who recommended that any commemorative naming be connected to a significant location closely tied to nature and include an educational component explaining the importance of this renaming; and

Whereas, June is recognized as National Indigenous History Month in Canada, culminating in National Indigenous Peoples Day on June 21, providing an opportunity for the Town of Ajax to demonstrate its commitment to reconciliation; and

Therefore, be it resolved:

1. That Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion staff collaborate with Indigenous community partners to identify a suitable name and location for a commemorative naming that acknowledges the historical significance of the First Nations, Inuit, and Métis, to be presented to the Commemorative Naming Committee.

2. That an educational component be included at the selected location, such as interpretive signage or programming, that explains the significance of the name, location, and its connection to Indigenous history and culture; and

3. That the commemorative renaming be completed for a ceremonial unveiling by June 2026, including any related educational signage.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

9.2 **Ensuring Fair Funding for Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) Alternatives Across All Municipal Tiers**

Councillor Henry and Regional Councillor Crawford withdrew their motion regarding 'Ensuring Fair Funding for Automated Speed Enforcement (ASE) Alternatives Across All Municipal Tiers.'

9.3 **Solve the Crisis and Winter Homelessness Program Support**

Councillor Bower and Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

Whereas, we are approaching the cold winter months and the number of people experiencing homelessness in Ajax and Durham Region continues to rise drastically,

with more than 1,000 people on Durham Region's by-name list as of August, including specifically 200 people in Ajax seeking support to change their housing status[1]; and

Whereas, in September 2024, Ajax Council passed a motion to support Ontario Big City Mayors (OBCM) SolvetheCrisis.ca[2] campaign requesting that the provincial and federal governments take immediate action to solve the homelessness and mental health crisis gripping our communities; and

Whereas, while the provincial government has provided support for new programs such as Homeless and Addiction Recovery Treatment Hubs (HART Hubs), it does not adequately address the growing crisis and the financial and social impact on municipalities and regions; and

Whereas, according to the Association of Municipalities of Ontario, municipalities are providing 51.5% of the total reported homelessness program funding across all three levels of government, making a significant financial impact on municipal budgets[3]; and

Whereas, OBCM recently passed a motion at their October Meeting re-iterating the need for provincial support in addressing this crisis by allocating more funding to programs that address chronic homelessness; and

Therefore, be it resolved:

1. That Ajax Council reconfirms their support of the Solve the Crisis Campaign and calls on Ajax residents to join us in appealing to the provincial and federal governments for support by visiting SolveTheCrisis.ca; and

2. That Ajax Council asks that the provincial government to take action on the requests of the Solve the Crisis Campaign that have not been fully addressed including:

    a. Appoint a responsible ministry and Minister with the appropriate funding and powers as a single point of contact to address the full spectrum of housing needs as well as mental health, addictions and wrap around supports.

    b. This single Minister must strike a task force with sector representatives including municipalities, health care leaders, first responders, community services, the business community, and the tourism industry to develop an Ontario Action Plan.

    c. Provide municipalities with the tools and resources to transition those in encampments to more appropriate supports, when deemed necessary.

    d. Commit to funding the services our unhoused population needs, community by community, to fill in gaps in the system.

    e. Invest in 24/7 community hubs or crisis centres to relieve pressure on emergency departments and first responders; and

3. That Ajax Council asks that the provincial government prepares a 2025/2026 winter homelessness response plan to help municipalities ensure that we can keep our unsheltered residents who are sleeping outdoors with the services they need to keep them safe in colder weather; and

4. That a copy of this resolution be sent to Doug Ford, Premier of Ontario, Rob Cerjanec, MPP for Ajax, local MPPs across the Region of Durham, Durham Regional Council, all Ontario Municipalities, Ontario Big City Mayors (OBCM).

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-laws 83-2025 to 86-2025 and By-law 88-2025 be approved.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: L. Bower

That By-law 89-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on November 17, 2025, be approved.

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the November 17, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (4:47 p.m.)

In Favour: Regional Councillor Crawford, Councillor Tyler Morin, Regional Councillor Lee, Councillor Henry, Councillor Bower

Opposed: None

CARRIED

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Mayor and CEO

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Clerk